

PART 21: ADDENDUM — GAP-FILL TOPICS

After reviewing the inventory, this addendum covers topics that received lighter treatment than they deserved or were referenced but not deepened. It is intentionally compact — these are reference treatments, not full chapters.

21.1 OKR Setting and Workshops

OKRs (Objectives and Key Results) were introduced in Part 4 and referenced elsewhere. Here's the practical workshop guide.

What OKRs Actually Are

- **Objective:** Qualitative, inspirational, time-bound. Captures what success looks like.
- **Key Results:** 2-4 quantitative, measurable outcomes that confirm achievement.

OKRs are *not* tasks, projects, or features. They are outcomes.

Bad vs Good OKRs

Bad Objective: "Improve onboarding." **Good Objective:** "Become the easiest path to value for new SaaS users in our category."

Bad Key Result: "Ship the new onboarding flow." (That's a task.) **Good Key Result:** "Increase D7 activation from 22% to 35% (with NPS guardrail of >50)."

Setting Quarterly OKRs

A practical workshop:

Pre-work (each team member, 1 week):

- What's the most important thing we should achieve this quarter?
- What metric would demonstrate it?

Workshop session (2 hours):

1. Surface candidate objectives.
2. Reduce to 2-3 objectives max.
3. For each: brainstorm 4-5 candidate KRs.
4. Reduce to 2-3 KRs per objective.

5. Set targets — ambitious but achievable.
6. Identify guardrails.

Post-workshop:

- Manager review.
- Cross-team alignment.
- Team commits.

OKR Review Cadence

- **Weekly:** Quick check on progress.
- **Monthly:** Real review; adjust if reality diverges.
- **End-of-quarter:** Score (0.0 to 1.0); discuss what worked, what didn't.

Common OKR Mistakes

- **Too many.** 10 objectives = 0 priorities.
- **Confusing tasks for KRs.** "Ship X" is not a KR.
- **Sandbagging.** Setting targets you'll definitely hit. Real OKRs should be achievable at 70%, stretch at 100%.
- **Not retiring missed OKRs.** When you miss, learn and move on; don't carry forever.
- **Top-down imposition.** OKRs work best when teams own them.

21.2 Privacy by Design

Referenced in Part 14. Practical detail:

Six Privacy by Design Principles (Ann Cavoukian)

1. **Proactive, not reactive.** Anticipate privacy issues; don't wait for breaches.
2. **Privacy as default.** User's most-private setting is default.
3. **Privacy embedded in design.** Not bolted on.
4. **Full functionality.** Privacy and usability both.
5. **End-to-end security.** Lifecycle protection.
6. **Visibility and transparency.** Users see what's collected and why.

PM Practices

- **Privacy review before any new data collection.** What's collected? Why? How long retained? Who accesses?
- **Minimum data principle.** Don't collect what you don't need.
- **Anonymization where possible.** Hashing, pseudonymization.

- **Clear in-product controls.** Users should manage their data.
- **Indian DPDP Act compliance** (as of 2024-2025). Stay current.
- **Cross-border data flows.** Many regulations restrict (Indian DPDP, GDPR, etc.).

Privacy Maturity Stages

- **Stage 1: Compliance.** Legal team handles; minimum effort.
- **Stage 2: Risk management.** Avoid breaches.
- **Stage 3: User-centric.** Privacy as feature; controls visible.
- **Stage 4: Privacy advantage.** Differentiation. Apple's branding around this.

PMs should aspire to Stage 3-4.

21.3 Localization Beyond Translation

Referenced in Part 9 / 13. Deeper:

Localization is more than translating strings. It's adapting the product to a market.

Components of Real Localization

1. **Language and copy.** Translate, but also adapt tone and idioms.
2. **Number / date / currency formats.** ₹ vs \$ vs €; lakhs vs millions.
3. **Imagery.** Faces, settings, product photos that match the market.
4. **Cultural sensitivity.** Calendars, holidays, religious considerations.
5. **Legal / regulatory.** GDPR, DPDP, etc.
6. **Payment methods.** UPI in India, Pix in Brazil, Alipay in China.
7. **Customer support channels.** WhatsApp in India, WeChat in China.
8. **Local trust signals.** Indian regulator badges; certifications.
9. **Right-to-left support.** Arabic, Hebrew. UI mirroring.
10. **Length variability.** German is 30% longer; Chinese is shorter.

Localization Priorities by Market Size

- **Tier 1 (>15% MAU):** Full localization.
- **Tier 2 (5-15%):** Translated UI + key support docs.
- **Tier 3 (<5%):** Possibly machine-translated or English.

Indian Vernacular UI Specifically

For Indian markets:

- **Hindi** has the broadest reach.

- **Tamil, Telugu, Bengali, Marathi, Kannada, Malayalam, Punjabi, Gujarati** for regional markets.
- Voice interfaces underrated for non-English-script-comfortable users.
- **Glyph fonts** matter — bad font rendering destroys experience.
- **Number formatting** in Indian English (lakhs, crores, "1,00,000" vs "100,000").

21.4 Working with QA / Test Teams

Referenced in Part 6. Practical detail:

QA Models

Engineering-owned testing: Engineers write unit and integration tests. PM ensures critical paths covered.

Dedicated QA team: Separate function. Plans test strategies, runs exploratory testing, manages bug DB.

Hybrid: Engineers test their work; QA team handles regression and exploratory.

What PMs Owe QA

- Clear acceptance criteria in PRDs.
- Time for testing in the schedule (don't squeeze).
- Definition of "done" jointly agreed.
- Triage support for bugs found.

What QA Owes PM

- Coverage of critical paths.
- Clear bug reports (steps to reproduce, expected vs actual).
- Prioritization recommendations.
- Test results before launch.

Bug Triage

PMs typically lead bug triage:

- **P0 (critical):** Blocks core functionality. Fix immediately.
- **P1 (high):** Significant impact; fix in current cycle.
- **P2 (medium):** Should fix; not blocking.
- **P3 (low):** Nice to fix.

Build the discipline of triaging weekly during development cycles.

21.5 Tech Debt Management

Referenced in Part 14. Deeper practical detail:

Tech Debt Quadrant (Ward Cunningham, refined)



The "Prudent" quadrant is acceptable — sometimes you knowingly take debt to ship now and pay later. The other quadrants are problematic.

How PMs Should Engage with Tech Debt

- **Treat it as a budget.** Allocate 15-25% of engineering capacity.
- **Make it visible.** Track in the same backlog as features.
- **Prioritize when it's blocking.** When debt is slowing development, pay it down.
- **Defend the budget.** Don't let stakeholder pressure push tech debt to "later."

Indicators You Have Too Much Debt

- Velocity declining over time.
- Engineer satisfaction declining.
- Estimates inflating.
- More time spent on bugs than features.
- Senior engineers leaving.

Indicators You're Managing It Well

- Steady velocity.
- Engineers can pick up new areas without months of context.
- Production incidents decreasing.
- Retention of senior engineers.

21.6 Indian Regulatory Landscape

Touched in Part 14 / 16. Deeper for Indian PMs:

Major Regulators

- **RBI (Reserve Bank of India).** Banking, payments, NBFCs, lending.
- **SEBI (Securities and Exchange Board).** Investments, mutual funds, brokers.
- **IRDAI.** Insurance.
- **TRAI.** Telecom (relevant for SMS, calls).
- **MEITY (Ministry of Electronics and IT).** Data protection (DPDP), IT rules.
- **CCI (Competition Commission).** Antitrust.
- **FSSAI.** Food safety.
- **DGCA.** Aviation.
- **Bar Council.** Legal services.
- **MCA (Ministry of Corporate Affairs).** Corporate compliance.

Key Frameworks

- **UPI** (NPCI-managed). Payment infrastructure.
- **Aadhaar / e-KYC** (UIDAI). Identity verification.
- **DigiLocker.** Document storage.
- **Account Aggregator** (RBI). Financial data sharing with consent.
- **GSTN.** Tax-related APIs.
- **OCEN** (Open Credit Enablement Network). Lending APIs.
- **ONDC** (Open Network for Digital Commerce). E-commerce alternative to walled gardens.

Compliance Obligations

For Indian fintech:

- KYC requirements.
- AML monitoring.
- RBI sandbox (for innovative products).
- Data localization (some categories).
- Consent frameworks.
- Audit and reporting.

For Indian healthtech:

- Telemedicine practice guidelines.
- Drug regulations.

- Patient data protection.

For e-commerce:

- Consumer protection rules.
- Marketplace vs inventory model distinctions.
- FDI policies.

What PMs Need to Do

- **Identify applicable regulations early** (PRD stage).
- **Build relationships with compliance / legal.**
- **Stay current.** Regulations evolve quickly in India.
- **Bake compliance into architecture** (audit logs, data lineage, etc.).
- **Don't skip review for "speed."** Regulatory issues can shut you down.

21.7 Documentation as a PM Deliverable

Documentation matters more than PMs realize.

Types of Documentation

1. Internal product docs:

- PRDs.
- Strategy memos.
- Roadmap docs.
- Decision logs.
- Retros.

2. External / customer docs:

- API documentation.
- Help center articles.
- Tutorials and getting started.
- Release notes.
- Changelogs.

Why It Matters

- **PRDs make execution efficient.**
- **Decision logs preserve institutional knowledge** as people leave.
- **API docs are the product** for developer companies.
- **Help docs reduce support load.**

- **Release notes communicate value.**

What Good Looks Like

- **Up to date.** Stale docs are worse than no docs.
- **Searchable.** Findable when needed.
- **Examples.** Concepts shown in context.
- **Diagrammed.** Visual where appropriate.
- **Maintained ownership.** Someone responsible.

PM's Role

- Write what only PM can write (strategy, PRDs).
- Review and improve other docs (help articles, release notes).
- Champion documentation as a culture.
- Audit: are our docs current?

21.8 Customer Success Collaboration

Touched in Parts 6, 13, 16. Deeper practical:

CS Health Score Models

A health score is a 0-100 indicator combining:

- **Product adoption** (logins, key actions, feature usage).
- **Engagement** (sessions, time, communications).
- **NPS / CSAT.**
- **Support ticket trends.**
- **Renewal proximity.**

CS uses these to prioritize outreach.

PM Engagement with Health Scores

- **Define what "healthy" means** for your product.
- **Validate** with real outcomes.
- **Iterate on weighting** based on what predicts churn or expansion.

Rescue Patterns

When a customer is unhealthy:

- **Adoption rescue:** Walk them through underused features.
- **Configuration rescue:** Fix issues blocking value.

- **Strategic rescue:** Align with their goals.
- **Last-resort:** Offer concession or accept churn.

Expansion Patterns

When a customer is healthy:

- **Usage-driven upgrades:** Hit a tier limit naturally.
- **Department expansion:** Add another team.
- **Multi-product:** Cross-sell adjacent features.
- **Upmarket:** Move from Pro to Business or Enterprise.

PM should design product surfaces to support both rescue and expansion.

21.9 Note-Taking and Knowledge Management for PMs

PMs accumulate enormous context. Without a system, you lose it.

What to Capture

- **Customer conversation notes** (transcripts + synthesized insights).
- **Decision logs** (what we decided, why, when).
- **Meeting notes** (especially decisions made).
- **Research findings.**
- **Personal reflections** (what I'm learning).

Tools

- **Notion / Roam / Obsidian:** for personal knowledge.
- **Confluence / Notion (workspace):** for team knowledge.
- **Otter / Fireflies:** transcription.
- **Loom:** video walkthroughs of complex things.

Patterns

- **Daily notes** (what happened today, decisions, opens).
- **Project pages** (per major initiative).
- **Customer pages** (per customer relationship).
- **Decision logs** with date, context, decision, rationale.

Why It Matters

- **Recall under pressure.** Two weeks later, you remember.

- **Onboarding successors.** When you change roles, knowledge transfers.
- **Pattern recognition over time.** Connecting dots across projects.
- **Defensible decisions.** When asked "why did we do X?", you have an answer.

21.10 Career Decisions — When to Stay vs Leave

Touched lightly. Here's a framework.

Reasons to Stay

- **Still learning.** Each year, you're better than the year before.
- **Trusted relationships compounding.**
- **Important work in progress.**
- **Strong manager-mentor.**
- **Reasonable compensation and growth.**

Reasons to Leave

- **Plateaued.** Same year, ten times.
- **Toxic environment.** Manager, culture, or specific dynamic.
- **Strategic misalignment.** You don't believe in the company's direction.
- **Compensation chronically below market.**
- **Career capital spent.** Other opportunities have higher upside.
- **Personal life requires it.** Family, health, location.

The Decision Process

1. **Honest assessment:** Is the issue solvable internally?
2. **Have you given it time?** New roles require 12-18 months to evaluate.
3. **What would you regret more — staying or leaving?**
4. **What's the alternative?** Don't leave for nothing; leave for something.
5. **Talk to mentors** (especially those who don't have a stake).

How to Leave Well

- **Give clear notice** (4 weeks standard; longer for senior roles).
- **Document handoff thoroughly.**
- **Don't badmouth.** The world is small; reputation compounds.
- **Stay in touch.** Former colleagues often become future opportunities.
- **Negotiate exit terms** thoughtfully (vesting, references).

21.11 PM Compensation and Equity

Brief practical reference.

Components

- **Base salary.** Predictable income.
- **Bonus.** Performance-tied.
- **Equity (RSUs at public companies, options at private).**
- **Sign-on bonus.** Often substantial at top tech.
- **Refreshers.** Annual equity grants.
- **Benefits.** Insurance, retirement, etc.

India-Specific

- Indian compensation is generally lower than US, even at same companies.
- Top Indian PMs at Big Tech (e.g., Google, Microsoft, Amazon) often earn ₹50L-3Cr total compensation depending on level.
- Indian unicorns: ₹40L-1.5Cr depending on level and stage.
- US-paid roles (remote / globally distributed) can pay 2-5x Indian rates.
- Equity in private companies: high variance.

Equity Math

If you're offered \$X equity:

- Vesting period (4 years standard).
- Cliff (1 year typical).
- Strike price (for options).
- Current valuation vs likely exit valuation.
- Tax implications.

Don't assume equity is worth its current valuation. Most startups don't reach unicorn outcomes.

Negotiation

(Cross-reference Part 17.)

Always negotiate. Recruiters expect it. Most underflexed candidates leave 10-30% on the table.

21.12 Building & Running a PM Team (For Senior PMs)

Touched in Part 10. More practical:

When You Become a Manager

The transition from IC to manager is significant:

- You stop shipping; you ship through people.
- Your day is 80% conversations.
- You're judged on team output, not personal output.

First 90 Days as PM Manager

Days 1-30: Listen and observe.

- 1:1s with each team member.
- Stakeholder meetings.
- Read team's artifacts.
- Don't make changes yet.

Days 31-60: Diagnose.

- What's working?
- What's broken?
- Where's the team's energy?

Days 61-90: Reset.

- Set vision and priorities.
- Address top 1-2 issues.
- Build rituals (1:1s, team meetings, retros).

Hiring PMs

(Cross-reference Part 16.)

- Define the role's seniority and scope.
- Multi-stage interview loop.
- Reference checks beyond the candidate's chosen list.
- Trial projects when possible.

Performance Reviews

- Calibrate expectations against company levels.
- Specific behavioral feedback (not just outcomes).

- Career growth conversations separately from review.
- Write down concerns early; don't let them fester.

When to Let Someone Go

- Performance gaps despite explicit feedback and support.
- Cultural / values misalignment that doesn't resolve.
- Skills gap with no path to closing.

Difficult conversations. But avoiding them harms the rest of the team.

Books to Read When Moving to Management

- *The Manager's Path* — Camille Fournier.
- *High Output Management* — Andy Grove.
- *Radical Candor* — Kim Scott.
- *Trillion Dollar Coach* — Schmidt et al.
- *The Making of a Manager* — Julie Zhuo.

21.13 Summary — What This Addendum Filled

This addendum addressed:

- OKR setting workshops (Part 4 reference).
- Privacy by Design (Part 14 reference).
- Localization beyond translation (Part 9, 13 reference).
- Working with QA / Test (Part 6 reference).
- Tech debt management (Part 14 reference).
- Indian regulatory landscape (Part 14, 16 reference).
- Documentation as deliverable (Part 6, 10 reference).
- Customer Success collaboration (Part 13, 16 reference).
- Note-taking and knowledge management (Part 19 reference).
- Career decisions (Part 1, 19 reference).
- Compensation and equity (Part 17 reference).
- Building PM teams (Part 10, 16 reference).

These are reference treatments. Each could be its own chapter. Use them as pointers and starting points; deepen as needed for your specific context.

End of Part 21 (Addendum). The textbook is complete. The next step is to assemble all 21 parts into the final Word document.